

FMEA for the Support Call Process

Purpose

FMEA is a structured way to list how each step in a process can fail, what the effect would be, and how likely and detectable that failure is. We then calculate a Risk Priority Number (RPN) to focus on the most important items. [web:594][web:597][web:598]

Simple FMEA Table

Process Step	Failure Mode	Effect	Cause	S (1-10)	O (1-10)	D (1-10)	RPN = S×O×D
Identify request	Agent misunderstands main issue	Long call, wrong solution	Poor listening, no probing questions	7	4	4	112
Research / Resolve	Agent cannot find correct article	Customer on hold, possible wrong answer	Slow, cluttered knowledge base	8	6	5	240
Transfer	Unnecessary transfer	Longer call, customer frustration	Unclear policy on billing ownership	8	5	5	200
Wrap-up	Inaccurate notes	Follow-up calls, rework	Rushed documentation	6	4	6	144

Interpretation

The highest RPNs are for “cannot find correct article” and “unnecessary transfer.” These match the earlier Cause & Effect work and support the decision to focus first on knowledge base improvements and clearer billing policies in the Improve phase.